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CORPORATE ANALYTICS OFFICE | AUDIENCE INTELLIGENCE UNIT

Corporate Audience Overlap & Media Synergy Study

A governance-approved summary of cross-category consumer affinity, owned-channel media leverage, and campaign fit for Highland Studios' portfolio planning cycle.

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Highland Studios Strategy Task Force

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RELEASE CONDITIONS

This document is an approved analytical summary produced after governance review. It intentionally excludes raw identifiers, household-level viewing paths, precise purchase histories, and any export that

would allow direct re-identification of individuals.

Percentages should be interpreted as directional planning indicators, not deterministic conversion forecasts.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report evaluates potential brand alignment and cross-promotional synergies between Highland Studios' upcoming project directions and the broader media ecosystem owned by the parent corporation. The parent company's relevant assets include a streaming service with 62M active accounts, fashion merchandising, youth-culture lifestyle publications, licensed talent access, and owned social channels.

The strongest finding is that creative self-expression travels well across the group portfolio. Lifestyle and cozy-media overlap reaches 82% among players who bought Highland's action-sports titles, especially where character styling, home or space decoration, music identity, creator tutorials, and fashion-led social content are present. By contrast, motorsport broadcast overlap is materially narrower: only 24% of general corporate subscribers overlap with racing simulation buyers, with concentration in core sports channels and lower reach through lifestyle or merchandising units.

In portfolio planning terms, a title with heavy customization, self-expression, and social sandbox structures can use corporate owned media more efficiently than a traditional racing sequel. Full life-simulation concepts show comparable audience reach but materially higher execution sensitivity. Traditional racing remains commercially viable as a lower-volatility

production path, but it lacks the same corporate demographic leverage and would require a higher share of paid marketing spend to achieve comparable visibility.



Objective, Scope, and Analytical Method

The Strategy Task Force asked whether Highland Studios' parent-company ecosystem provides meaningful audience leverage across relevant genre and concept territories. The analysis focuses on whether existing entertainment, lifestyle, commerce, and publication audiences can reduce go-to-market friction, increase credibility, or create lower-cost discovery loops for a new Highland title.

The question is not simply whether parent-company consumers play games. The more useful question is whether the group's audiences already demonstrate behaviors that resemble the emotional and social use cases of a proposed game: identity formation, character styling, episodic viewing, competitive fandom, collection behavior, social sharing, creator imitation, and willingness to buy adjacent merchandise.

1.1 APPROVED DATA SOURCES

SOURCE	COVERAGE	REFRESH	ANALYTICAL USE	GOVERNANCE TREATMENT
Streaming account taxonomy	62M active accounts across entertainment, sport, and youth-culture verticals	Quarterly	Media affinity, format preference, co-viewing context	Aggregated cohorts only
Merchandise transaction segments	Fashion, collectible, event, and limited-edition drops	Monthly	Commerce conversion and style-led purchasing	Spend bands, no raw transaction export
Lifestyle publication audiences	Editorial readers and newsletter subscribers across youth culture, design, sport, and music	Monthly	Topic resonance and creator-led feature fit	Topic clusters; no named reader lists
Highland historical buyers	Prior racing, skateboarding, and simulation title purchasers	Historical snapshot	Gaming baseline and franchise affinity	Hashed and cohort-matched
Social content engagement	Owned-channel posts, trailer reactions, creator clips, and editorial shares	Weekly	Content format performance and message testing	Aggregate engagement only

Source: Corporate Analytics Office approved release CAO-AUD-26-Q2-117. Sample thresholds suppress cohorts below governance minimums.

METHOD NOTE

Overlap percentages measure observed co-affinity within the parent-company ecosystem. They do not assert that every overlapping consumer will purchase a game. The values are most useful for comparing the relative ease of reaching, explaining, and validating each project concept through owned channels.

Audience Universe and Overlap Findings

The approved parent-company universe is broad, but the gaming-relevant portion is not evenly distributed across genres. Racing buyers are concentrated in sports-viewing and vehicle-culture pockets. Skateboarding and lifestyle-sports buyers are spread across streetwear, music, short-form creator culture, fashion drops, and design-led streaming categories. Life-simulation intenders show lower existing Highland familiarity, but high alignment with customization, home-space, relationship-story, and cozy-media signals.

Observed Cross-Category Affinity by Highland-Relevant Segment

Share of each gaming segment showing high affinity with selected parent-company media and commerce categories.

Action-sports buyers to lifestyle/cozy media



Skate buyers to fashion and music drops



Life-sim intenders to home/style series



Motorsport players to sports channels



General subscribers to racing buyers



18.7M

reachable accounts with both gaming and identity-expression signals

11.4M

accounts showing repeat engagement with customization, decor, fashion, or creator-led tutorials

4.2M

accounts showing strong racing or motorsport affinity but low lifestyle-content breadth

2.1 AUDIENCE INTERPRETATION

The scale advantage sits with concepts that can be explained through identity and social creativity. Parent-company channels already know how to package fashion edits, character-led stories, creator transformations, room makeovers, playlist identity, and aspirational lifestyle routines. These formats translate naturally to a customizable sports-lifestyle or life-simulation concept.

Racing concepts can still benefit from sports channels, motorsport documentaries, and high-performance equipment partnerships. However, the data suggests that racing requires a more specialised message and reaches fewer casual entertainment subscribers through the parent portfolio.

Cross-Category Engagement Indices

To compare concepts on a like-for-like basis, the Analytics Office created a Cross-Category Engagement Index. A score of 100 represents average cross-category fit for a recent mid-budget game launch within the group. Scores above 130 indicate that the concept can plausibly be supported with unusually efficient owned media, editorial, or commerce integrations.

Candidate Concept	Streaming Affinity	Editorial Fit	Merchandise Fit	Creator Content Fit	Composite Index
Life-simulation category entry	172	151	138	166	157
Customization-led street-sports concept	148	166	171	159	161
Skateboarding franchise extension	118	132	147	135	133
Motorsport management and lifestyle concept	91	96	107	82	94
Traditional racing sequel category	78	72	83	61	74

3.1 Concept-to-Asset Fit Heatmap

Genre / Concept Territory	Streaming	Fashion	Lifestyle Press	Creator Network	Sports Channels	Commerce
Traditional racing sequel category	2	1	1	2	5	2
Skateboarding franchise extension	3	5	4	4	2	4
Customization-led street-sports concept	5	5	5	5	3	5
Life-simulation category entry	5	4	5	5	1	4
Motorsport management and lifestyle concept	2	3	3	2	4	3

Heatmap scale: 1 = weak fit, 3 = workable fit, 5 = strong fit. Ratings combine reach, message credibility, expected content supply, and internal activation cost.

Owned Media and Commerce Synergy Model

The parent-company advantage is most valuable where the group can provide credible discovery without buying every impression externally. The model below separates paid acquisition from owned media, partner editorial, and commerce-led discovery. Customization-heavy concepts shift more of the launch burden toward channels already controlled by the corporation.

Audience Signal

Identity expression, character styling, lifestyle aspiration, creator imitation, and social sharing detected across streaming and editorial cohorts.



Activation Surface

Series placements, fashion drops, youth-culture articles, creator challenges, playlist moments, and short-form explainers.



Game Demand

Wishlist additions, launch trial intent, community sharing, avatar-item interest, and lower dependence on paid reach.

Illustrative Launch-Reach Mix by Project Concept

Estimated share of reachable launch impressions by channel type under a standard group-supported campaign.

Skateboarding Sequel



Life Simulation Reboot



Open-World Street Sports

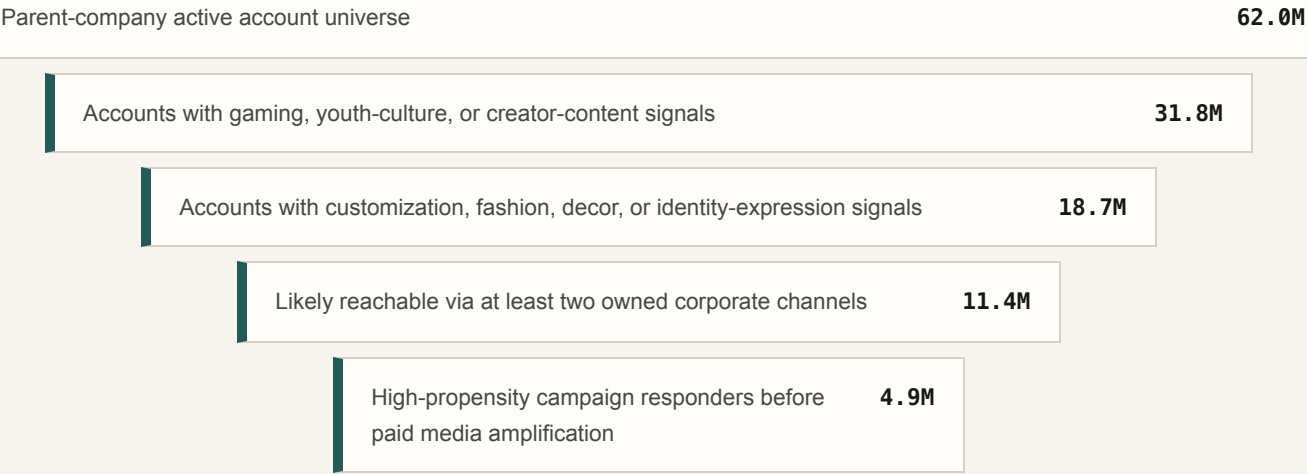


Racing Sequel

39% non-paid

Owned media Partner/editorial Paid acquisition

4.1 CAMPAIGN FUNNEL FOR CUSTOMIZATION-LED CONCEPTS



PLANNING INTERPRETATION

A larger reachable audience does not remove the need for a strong game concept or stable technology. It does, however, lower the cost of initial explanation. Concepts that are easy to show through outfits, social spaces, room builds, tricks, stories, or creator challenges are easier for the parent-company portfolio to promote repeatedly.

Genre and Concept Implications

The data does not make the final project decision by itself. Highland must still weigh studio capability, production risk, historical failures, expected development cost, and competitor timing. However, the parent-company overlap analysis changes the marketing side of the decision: the group can create the most leverage for concepts that combine social identity, creator content, and customisable consumer-facing assets.

5.1 GENRE-LEVEL READOUT

CONCEPT TERRITORY	CORPORATE AUDIENCE LEVERAGE	BEST ACTIVATION ROUTE	PRIMARY LIMITATION	PLANNING IMPLICATION
Traditional racing sequel category	Low	Sports channels, motorsport documentary inventory, specialist creator campaigns	Narrow general-subscriber overlap; low fashion and lifestyle editorial fit	Keep if production certainty dominates. Budget for higher paid acquisition.
Skateboarding franchise extension	Medium	Streetwear drops, creator tricks, soundtrack tie-ins, youth press	Strong but concentrated around known franchise fans	Solid fit, though less strategically expansive than a street sports concept.
Customization-led street-sports concept	Very High	Fashion, music, creator stunts, avatar styling, social hubs, trick sharing	Needs clear product definition to avoid becoming unfocused	Best balance between Highland capability and parent-company leverage.
Life-simulation category entry	High	Home design, character stories, relationship drama, cozy series adjacency	Highest technical and reputational risk due to prior LifeSpace failure	Large upside, but only with credible engineering remediation and staged scope.
Motorsport management and lifestyle concept	Moderate	Sports personalities, team-livery commerce, management strategy content	Niche audience; difficult to make broadly legible in youth/lifestyle channels	Efficient smaller project, but limited transformational potential.

5.2 RECOMMENDED ACTIVATION SEQUENCE FOR A CUSTOMIZATION-LED STREET-SPORTS LAUNCH

T-9 months	Soft editorial seeding through youth-culture publications: "new social sports spaces", character identity, music, fashion, and city movement themes. No hard sell before gameplay clarity.
T-6 months	Creator prototype sessions focused on avatar styling, trick expression, social hub traversal, and shareable challenge formats. Capture feedback before content-lock.
T-3 months	Limited merchandise test: digital outfit concepts mirrored by small real-world capsule drops. Measure click-through and wishlist lift by style cluster.

Launch month	Synchronized streaming-service inventory, creator challenge week, lifestyle press features, and store-page conversion tests. Paid media supports proof points that owned channels have already validated.
Post-launch	Monthly creator prompts, player-designed looks, seasonal social events, and commerce tie-ins. Avoid a single launch spike; design for repeatable identity-led content.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

A customization-led street-sports concept appears to capture the most useful middle ground: it preserves Highland's credibility in physics-driven movement while adding the identity-expression layer that the parent-company ecosystem can promote at scale. A full life-simulation category entry has comparable audience upside but materially higher engineering and reputational risk.

Risks, Caveats, and Governance Limits

Corporate audience fit can become misleading if treated as a substitute for product-market fit. The parent company can amplify a concept that matches its audiences, but it cannot make an unstable game retain players, nor can it guarantee that streaming viewers convert into buyers at a profitable rate.

ANALYTICAL RISK

High affinity may reflect content interest rather than purchase intent. Consumers who enjoy fashion, decor, or social storytelling may still reject a game if onboarding is weak, price is too high, or community tools feel shallow.

EXECUTION RISK

The more a game relies on self-expression, the more it needs robust customization tools, moderation processes, content pipelines, and reliable social systems. These requirements must be costed before the audience upside is banked.

6.1 SPECIFIC CAVEATS

CAVEAT	WHY IT MATTERS	MITIGATION
Correlation is not conversion	Overlap measures shared affinity, not guaranteed purchasing behavior.	Run store-page tests, wishlist tracking, and prototype creator sessions before final go-to-market budget approval.
Different audience contexts	Streaming viewers are often passive; game buyers need control, agency, and value.	Translate media hooks into playable loops, not just campaign imagery.
Privacy and governance suppression	Low-volume cohorts are intentionally hidden, reducing precision in smaller segments.	Use larger directional ranges and avoid overfitting decisions to small subgroup patterns.
Prior LifeSpace reputational memory	Life-simulation players may remember technical failures and demand proof of stability.	Publish transparent technical milestones only when verified; consider staged alpha proof before broad brand campaigns.

Recommendations for the Strategy Task Force

The parent-company audience data should be treated as a strategic multiplier, not as the sole decision criterion. If the Task Force chooses a concept that already fits Highland's delivery capability, the parent ecosystem can materially reduce launch friction. If the Task Force chooses a concept beyond current capability, audience fit alone will not offset execution failure.

RECOMMENDATION	ACTION	DECISION USE
R-1	Prioritise a customization-led street-sports concept as the strongest audience-leverage candidate, subject to product-scope discipline and technical feasibility review.	Best balance of parent-company media leverage and Highland's street-sports capability base.
R-2	Keep a full life-simulation category entry under consideration only if the studio can demonstrate a credible remediation plan for AI simulation, save-state reliability, and mod/customization tooling.	High market and media upside, but unacceptable if historical LifeSpace weaknesses remain unresolved.
R-3	If a traditional racing sequel is selected, plan for a more conventional paid acquisition model and do not assume broad parent-company lifestyle support.	Prevents underbudgeting a lower-overlap but lower-production-risk project.
R-4	Run a two-week concept validation sprint comparing a racing sequel trailer, an open-world street sports prototype, and a life-sim customization slice using matched owned-channel placements.	Turns the current directional analysis into campaign-response evidence before final greenlight.

FINAL READOUT

The corporate ecosystem is structurally better at amplifying identity, style, creator behavior, and social storytelling than pure motorsport realism. This creates a measurable advantage for customization-led projects. The most defensible strategic interpretation is that corporate audience data strengthens the case for a customization-led street-sports concept and, with stronger technical controls, may support a full life-simulation category entry. It does not materially strengthen the case for a traditional racing sequel.

APPENDIX - DEFINITIONS AND METHODOLOGY NOTES

Cross-Category Engagement Index: A composite measure normalised to 100, combining reach, repeat engagement, content format fit, editorial credibility, merchandise adjacency, and expected activation cost. Scores above 130 indicate strong cross-portfolio leverage.

High affinity: A cohort-level classification assigned when observed engagement is materially above the parent-company baseline for a given topic or format. Affinity does not require direct purchase behavior.

Owned-channel efficiency: Estimated ability to generate credible awareness through streaming inventory, editorial, newsletters, social channels, commerce moments, and talent integrations controlled by the corporation before external paid media is applied.

Governance suppression: Cohorts below minimum size thresholds are suppressed or aggregated. The analysis therefore favors stable directional conclusions over precise micro-segment claims.

Classification: Confidential. This summary is approved for Highland Studios Strategy Task Force use within internal portfolio planning channels. Do not distribute outside approved corporate review groups.